

MODULE 3

The Inbox — Every Conversation in One Place

Goal: Never miss a message. Manage email, WhatsApp, and all channels from a single inbox with a clear triage habit.

IN THIS MODULE

- 01 What the Unified Inbox is and why it replaces your email tab
- 02 Conversation statuses: Open, Unread, Resolved — building a triage habit
- 03 Assigning conversations to teammates and filtering by channel
- 04 Replying, using templates, and attaching files
- 05 Connecting email and WhatsApp channels

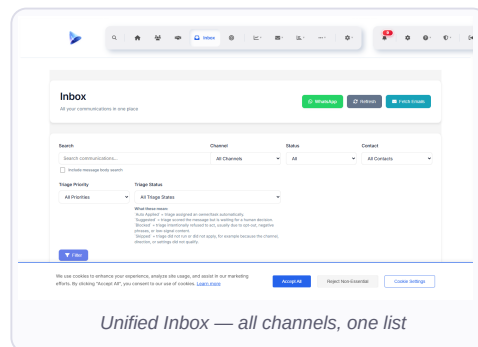
The Unified Inbox

The Inbox aggregates every customer conversation — email, WhatsApp, SMS — into one view, linked to the contact record. You never need to switch between your email client and the CRM again.

? *A unified inbox prevents conversations from falling through the cracks when colleagues are away or channels are missed.*

- All channels in one list: email, WhatsApp, SMS
- Each thread is linked to a contact — click to see their full history
- Unread count shown as a badge on the Inbox nav icon
- Filter by channel, status, triage priority, or contact name
- Status shows: Open, Resolved, Archived

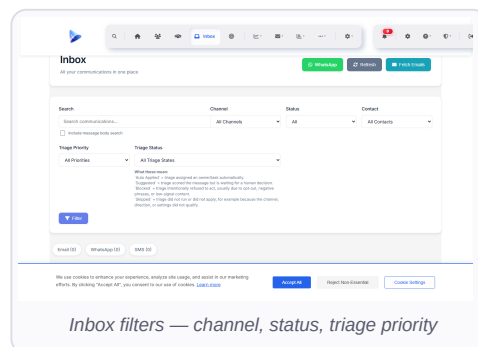
? **Open the Inbox every morning before checking your regular email. This is now your primary communication dashboard.**



Triage: Open ? Reply ? Resolve

The triage habit is simple: every conversation moves from Open to Resolved. If you replied and it needs a follow-up, it stays Open. If the thread is complete, mark it Resolved.

- Open — needs your attention or is awaiting a reply
- Resolved — conversation complete, no action needed
- Archived — keep for records, remove from active view
- Unread — new message received, not yet viewed
- Priority labels — tag high-priority threads for urgent triage



Replying and Using Templates

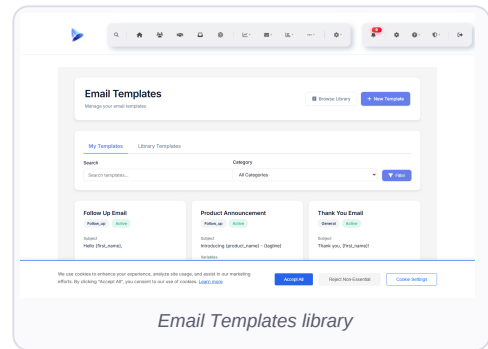
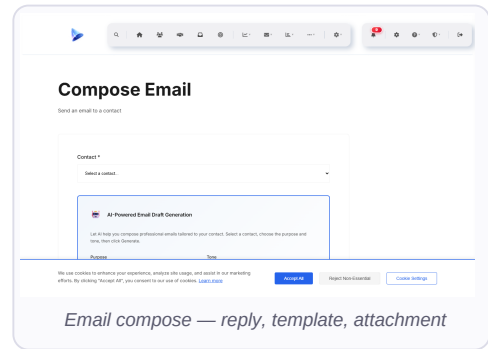
When you open a conversation, you can reply directly from the Inbox. Use email templates to send polished, consistent messages in seconds — no copy-pasting.

- Click a thread to open the conversation view
- Type a reply or click Templates to insert a saved response
- Attach files — proposals, invoices, or spec sheets
- Assign the conversation to a teammate if it needs handoff
- Mark as Resolved when the thread is closed

Email Templates — Save Time on Every Reply

Templates are pre-written messages you can insert with one click. Build a library of templates for your most common scenarios: intro, follow-up, proposal send, rejection handling.

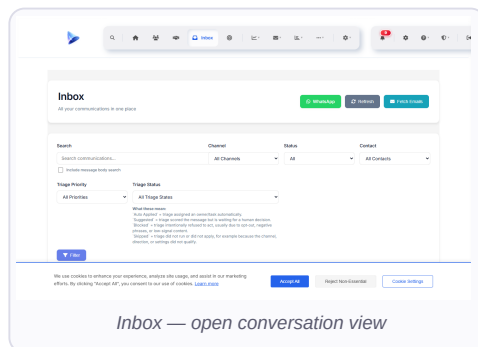
- Find templates at Communications ? Email Templates
- Templates support merge fields: {first_name}, {company}, {deal_value}
- Create templates for: intro, follow-up, proposal, decline, re-engagement
- A good template saves 3–5 minutes per reply — 20+ replies/day = 1 hour saved



Assigning & Filtering Conversations

If you have a team, assign conversations to the right person. Use filters to focus your view on what matters to you right now.

- Assign — transfer ownership to a teammate who can best handle it
- Filter by Channel — see only email, only WhatsApp, or only SMS
- Filter by Contact — see all threads from one company or person
- Filter by Status — isolate Open threads to work your triage queue
- Search — find a conversation by keyword or contact name



Inbox — open conversation view

? Module 3 Exercise — Inbox

Step-by-step:

- 1 Open the Inbox. Count your unread messages. Set a goal: zero unread by end of day.
- 2 Open 5 conversations. For each: read, reply or note-to-self, then set status (Open/Resolved).
- 3 Find a conversation that needs a teammate — assign it to them with a note.
- 4 Use a template to reply to one conversation. Edit the merge fields before sending.
- 5 Filter by WhatsApp channel. Review all WhatsApp threads and resolve the completed ones.
- 6 Set up a triage habit: Open Inbox at 9am, 1pm, and 4pm each day.

QUICK REFERENCE

- Inbox = your primary communication hub. Check it before email.
- Triage habit: Open ? Reply ? Resolve. Nothing stays unread overnight.
- Templates save 3–5 min per reply. Build your library in the first week.
- Assign conversations instead of forwarding emails — keeps history linked.
- Inbox URL: acrm.webxpanse.com/inbox.php